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Dear HopSkipDrive team,

An AI-assisted transportation plan still has to make sense to the person responsible for a student's trip. HopSkipDrive's focus on transparency, control, and trust is close to the design questions I work on: what a recommendation means, what someone can do with it, and how they recover when the expected action fails.

At FactorLab, I design SmartTagIt interactions with product and engineering. For the Flint assistant, I defined entry, waiting, and recovery flows, including different actions for an incomplete answer and a lost connection. For About Me, I developed reusable insight widgets that connect a summary to observations and next actions, while questioning what a comparison should imply. These projects required clear Figma states and an annotated handoff engineers could discuss and implement.

My research work helps me question the interaction before committing to a solution. At Oak AI, I connected usability evaluation with onboarding and navigation recommendations, making competing entry points explicit and proposing error feedback beside the affected field. At ASU, I proposed a learner-task prompt workflow with mentor review. I also built Prompt Compass to check whether a rewritten prompt preserves its original requirements. Each reflects a practical concern: a polished answer is useful only if it still supports the task.

For HopSkipDrive, I would start with one transportation-coordinator workflow and learn which information must be checked before a plan changes. I would prototype how to review a recommendation, recognize uncertainty, and recover from interruption, then test those moments with users and engineering. My strongest evidence is in enterprise interaction design and research; I would need to learn the transportation domain and your operational constraints.

I'm based in Mesa, Arizona, can start as soon as possible, and am authorized to work in the United States without sponsorship. I'd welcome a conversation about the design decisions this role would own and how my product and AI workflow experience could contribute.

Thank you,
Kyle Hobson

Portfolio prepared for HopSkipDrive:

<https://jonathankhobson.github.io/application-portfolios/hopskipdrive-product-designer/>